

BREAKUP RECOVERY GUIDE

breakup-recovery.org

You picked this up for a reason.

That reason matters.

Healing is not a straight line — it is a spiral.

Some days you will feel close to okay.

Some days you will not.

Both are part of the journey.

Be gentle with yourself as you read.

There is no right way to do this.

There is only your way.

with love, Bruna & Pascal

Understanding the Breakup

Before you can heal, you need to make sense of what happened — not to assign blame, but so your nervous system can begin to feel safe again.

Why it hurts this much

Romantic loss activates the same neural pathways as physical pain. This is not weakness — it is biology.

Attachment bonds

You are not just grieving a person. You are grieving a future, a routine, and a version of yourself.

Types of endings

Mutual, sudden, gradual fade, betrayal — each type of breakup carries its own grief shape and timeline.

Asking better questions

Not "what did I do wrong?" but "what did this relationship show me about what I truly need?"

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"Understanding is not the same as accepting — but it is the door that acceptance walks through."

REFLECT & JOURNAL

What was the moment I knew this relationship was ending — and what did I feel in my body? -----

What story am I telling myself about why it ended? Is that story helping or hurting me? -----

What did this relationship give me that I valued most? What was I longing for that it could not give? -----

Managing Emotions

You will feel things you do not expect — grief, relief, rage, hope, shame — sometimes all in one afternoon. Learning to work with emotions rather than against them is at the heart of healing.

01 Name it to tame it

Labelling an emotion shifts it from physical overwhelm to something your mind can begin to process.

02 Feel it, then release it

Set a timer for 10 minutes to fully feel — cry, write, move — then consciously step out of it.

03 Watch for the spiral

Processing emotion moves through you. Ruminating circles. Notice the difference.

04 Regulate your nervous system

Physiological sigh: double inhale through the nose, long slow exhale. The fastest way to shift your state.

gentle reminder

- Anger is not a secondary emotion — it often carries important information about your boundaries and values. Do not rush past it.

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What emotion am I most afraid to feel right now? What do I think will happen if I let myself feel it fully?

When I notice myself spiralling, what am I really afraid of underneath those thoughts?

What does my body feel like when I am overwhelmed? Where do I hold it — chest, stomach, throat?

CHAPTER 03

Self-Care & Healing

Self-care during heartbreak is rebuilding the scaffolding your body and mind rely on when stress erodes the basics. It is one of the most loving things you can do for yourself right now.

Sleep first

Grief disrupts sleep. Create a wind-down ritual that signals safety to your nervous system each night.

Movement as medicine

20 minutes of gentle walking is enough. You do not need a gym — you need motion.

Nourish your body

Cortisol suppresses appetite. Eat small and often — your brain needs fuel to process grief.

Somatic self-holding

One hand on your chest, one on your belly. Cross your arms. This activates your co-regulation system.

Digital hygiene

Checking their profile releases cortisol, not closure.
Create distance from digital contact, even temporarily.

Expressive writing

Write what you would say to them. Do not send it. Feel the relief of expression without the complexity of response.

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Which basic need am I most neglecting — sleep, food, movement, or connection? What is one small thing I can do today?

How did I take care of myself before this relationship? What rituals did I let go of?

What does my body need most right now — rest, movement, touch, stillness?

CHAPTER 04

Rebuilding

Rebuilding is not returning to who you were before — it is constructing something stronger on the foundations the relationship revealed. This takes time, and that is completely okay.

- ♥ Reclaim pre-relationship interests. What did you love doing that gradually disappeared? Begin with one thing this week.
- ♥ Invest in platonic intimacy. Grief can make us forget we are loved — let people in your life show you otherwise.
- ♥ Audit your attachment patterns. This pain contains information about your relational blueprint — use it intentionally.
- ♥ Set one small goal per week. Not to distract, but to rebuild your sense of agency and forward motion.
- ♥ Allow yourself to want something different. What you accepted before does not define what you deserve next.

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"The person you become on the other side of this is not who you were before — they are more themselves."

REFLECT & JOURNAL

Who was I before this relationship? What parts of myself did I shrink, hide, or give up along the way?

What would I do this week if I were treating myself as someone truly worth investing in?

What is one belief about myself that this breakup reinforced — and is that belief actually true?

CHAPTER 05

Acceptance & Surrendering

Acceptance is not approval. It does not mean the breakup was okay. It means releasing your grip on what should have been — and making room for what is.

Releasing the narrative

The story of what happened can keep you tethered. Acceptance means holding that story more loosely.

Forgiving without condoning

Forgiveness is a gift to yourself, not to them. It does not require them to change or even apologise.

Surrendering control

We cannot control others' feelings or choices — only our response to them. Surrendering this is freedom.

gentle reminder

- Surrender is not the same as giving up. It is choosing to stop fighting reality — and finding out how much energy that frees.

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What am I still holding on to — a hope, a version of them, a future I imagined? What would it feel like to gently release it?

Is there something I need to forgive myself for? Can I offer myself the same compassion I would give a close friend?

What would change in my body if I fully accepted that this is over — not as defeat, but as truth?

Healthy Relationships

Before you are ready to love again, it helps to understand what a healthy relationship truly feels like — in your body, not just on paper.

01 Security feels different from excitement

Many of us confuse anxious attachment — the highs and lows — with passion. Safe love can feel unfamiliar at first.

02 Know your attachment style

Anxious, avoidant, disorganised, or secure — understanding how you attach helps you choose and behave differently.

03 Green flags matter as much as red ones

Practice noticing consistency, emotional availability, and repair after conflict — not just warning signs.

04 Relationships are a practice

Even the healthiest relationships require tending. Knowing this changes how you show up.

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What does safety feel like in my body — in a calm friendship, a gentle moment? Can I use that as a compass?

In past relationships, what did I tend to overlook or excuse? What was I afraid to ask for?

What does my ideal relationship feel like on an ordinary Tuesday — not a romantic night, just a regular day?

Embracing New Beginnings

A new beginning does not announce itself. It usually arrives quietly — a morning when the ache is a little lighter, a moment when you laugh and mean it. Start noticing these.

♥ Write a vision for the life — and love — you want to build. Not as a plan, but as a permission slip.

♥ Say yes to one thing each week that the old version of you would have skipped.

♥ Celebrate micro-moments. The first night you sleep through. The first week without checking their profile.

♥ Consider what kind of relationship you want to create — not just find — next time. You are a co-author.

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"A new beginning is not a return to who you were. It is an arrival into who you are becoming."

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What small sign of healing have I noticed recently — even the tiniest one? Can I honour it?

If I were not afraid, what is one thing I would do, try, or pursue right now?

What do I want the next chapter of my life to feel like — not look like, but feel like?

CHAPTER 08

Moving Forward

Moving forward does not mean forgetting. It means carrying this experience as wisdom rather than weight — and choosing, consciously, what comes next.

Integration over erasure

The goal is not to act like it never happened. It is to integrate the lesson and release the pain.

Trust yourself again

Heartbreak can erode self-trust. Rebuild it through small, kept promises to yourself — every single day.

Write your new story

Who are you now? What do you value? What will you no longer accept? Write it down and return to it.

gentle reminder

- You will know you have moved forward not because you no longer feel anything — but because you feel something new: possibility.

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What has this experience taught me about myself that I could not have learned any other way?

Who am I now that I was not before? What strength, clarity, or softness have I found through this?

What promise can I make to myself — and actually keep — starting today?

You do not have to heal alone.

Private 1:1 coaching with Bruna & Pascal.
Emergency calls available today.

Book a 1:1 Call — €79

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